

BLUE-

PRINT

FOR YOUR CHABAD HOUSE

Contributing Shluchim:
Rabbi Yossi Groner, Rabbi Zalman Marcus

הו נעשה במחשבה תחילה
—כך קובי

Your dream of being mekushar to the Rebbe through avodas hashlichus is finally being fulfilled. You're busy building a strong Jewish community, reaching out to fellow Yidden, creating programs and events, giving shiurim, and dedicating your time to spreading Yiddishkeit and Chassidus. It's a dream come true, except you forgot one detail: "the plan."

"Shlichus is a system of organization," says **Rabbi Yossi Groner**, Shliach in Charlotte, NC, and it is vital for a moisad to exist and thrive in today's shlichus environment. You need to plan for "the plan." Discard disorganization and adopt genuine organizational structures crucial to Shlichus growth.

Every shliach, before joining the ranks, aspires to a mission of reaching and affecting every single Jew to the best of his ability. He envisioned the ruchniedik dimension of shlichus; the outreach, the teaching, and the mitzvot. Yet who would have thought the mundane activities would be so preoccupying and challenging?

You need a strategy, a plan. A strategy entails choosing a direction and following its course. Competent execution of a well conceived strategy is the most powerful recipe for organizational success.

Absent a strategy, a shliach has no framework for weaving the individual peulos into a cohesive whole. The Chabad House is running, but on what?

Typically, a new Shliach will make himself available for every peulah that comes his way. He will try to give the best service and run to do every

task. Yet, as Rabbi Groner explains, "eventually he has to remove himself from that role by being organized and creating a set of priorities, by living those sets of priorities to become most efficient."

Planning for "the plan" covers five elements: vision, objectives, strategy, implementation, and evaluation.

VISION: THE BLUEPRINT

All things are created twice; first they are planned intellectually, then they are applied practically, "in the field."

In your mind, picture the final image of what you wish to build. Then, reduce it to a blueprint in preparation for construction. Failure to envision the final product, the physical creation, can cause very expensive changes down the road. As the old carpenters' saying goes, "measure twice and cut once."

Shlichus struggles tend to occur when the first stage isn't performed well or at all. Without a clear vision, you will run into problems such as undercapitalization, misunderstanding your territory, or lack of consistency.

Rabbi Zalman Marcus Shliach in Mission Viejo, CA encourages shluchim to take a year to truly understand and research the community before making any long term commitments. "Get a sense of the community, meet people, pound the pavement,

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test programs, interact, and get an idea of what they really need.” This will help you visualize where you are now and where you want to be in the future.

Form a vision that charts a course for the organization to pursue.

OBJECTIVES: THE ROADMAP

Suppose you were trying to reach a destination and someone handed you a map of the wrong city. How frustrating would that be? You could work on your attitude and behaviors, but they still won’t get you to your destination.

Too often we draw maps that depict the world as “we are” rather than as it truly is. That will steer us in the wrong direction. You may work extremely hard at shlichus, keep your faith strong and never let your spirits down, yet you may be following the wrong map. Attitude and behavior will not compensate for going in the wrong direction.

Objectives are the roadmap to your destination. Every peulah needs concrete and measurable objectives with a deadline for achievement. Those who set objectives and press forward with actions typically outperform those who only exhibit good intentions, try hard, and hope for the best.

Financial wellbeing is also a critical component of setting objectives. Establish a solid fundraising system with realistic expectations.

Objectives protect against complacency by creating disciplined efforts. As Rabbi Groner points out, “Benchmarks are to motivate you and not allow you to become satisfied. You can’t be on shlichus and be satisfied. You have to constantly elevate your goals, reach more people, and expand your influence. Ultimately this will result in bringing in more shluchim.”

Creating a vision and setting objectives is a leader’s primary role.

STRATEGY: THE PRESCRIPTION

Writing a prescription involves weighing the potential benefits against the risks. It is imperative that one diagnose before he prescribes. It is through the fine art of listening that a strategic solution emerges. It’s the shliach’s responsibility to ensure he is consistently involved with the issues that affect the big picture.

In order to successfully set a course of action, a shliach must listen to the problems and understand their challenges. His strategy must be both proactive (planned) and reactive (adopted). Because things don’t always go as planned, you need to adapt to changing circumstance.

Strategy concerns the “how to”:

- ✓ How to grow your Chabad House
- ✓ How to reach more Yidden
- ✓ How to bring more awareness to those you have attracted
- ✓ How to leverage your time
- ✓ How to pay your bills
- ✓ How to choose the right peulos for your community
- ✓ How to delegate effectively

At this stage the shliach exchanges his leadership fedora for his management beret. He might despise words like leverage or delegate, but as Rabbi Marcus explains, “the system includes management.” Shluchim must perform all aspects of

the shlichus. “Management” did not make the exceptions list.

Therefore, when management becomes a headache, it is nevertheless recommended that a shliach delegate to two people and follow up with them in the morning.

IMPLEMENTATION: THE GAME PLAN

The game plan is a well orchestrated sequence of events that maximizes team input for the best output. Winning is the summation of a perfectly executed strategy. The game plan helps assure that the end result, the culmination of your vision, will be as dreamed.

Implementation is fundamentally an action-oriented “make it happen” game-plan. It covers budgeting, policy making, motivating, culture building (“avir”), and leading all parts of the process. It harnesses competencies and capabilities by bringing out the best in your team players.

There are a number of basic requirements to operate a well organized and competently run Chabad House.

Basic requirements:

- ✓ Assembling the right team
- ✓ Assigning the right jobs to the right people
- ✓ Developing budgets that steer resources best positioned for success
- ✓ Setting policy and procedure
- ✓ Motivating people to pursue their targets
- ✓ Creating a great working environment and shlichus culture
- ✓ Ensuring great communication
- ✓ Monitoring progress for continuous improvements
- ✓ Exerting true leadership

In Rabbi Groner’s Chabad House they follow a simple game plan. “We have created templates and checklists for every project. Each shliach is assigned a project for which he is responsible to see that all tasks are executed.”

“...WINNING IS THE SUMMATION OF A PERFECTLY EXECUTED STRATEGY...”

When tasks are defined there is accountability. It is essential to organization and structure. It is perhaps the key indicator that you are operating at a major league level.

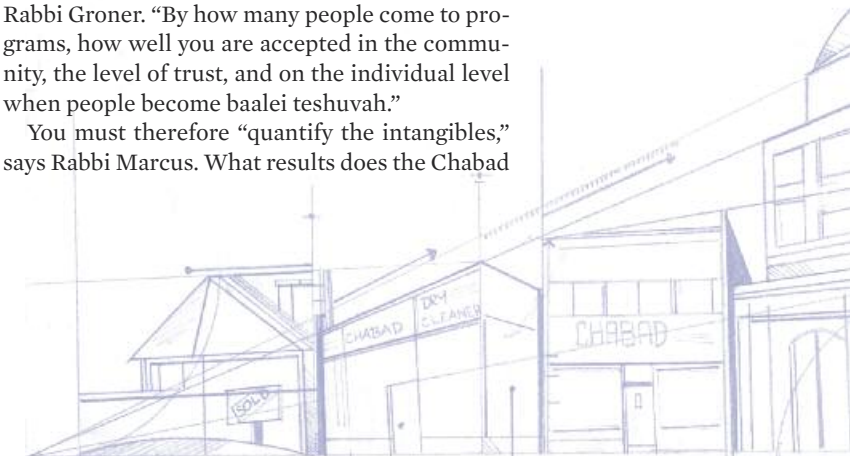
EVALUATION: THE REPORT CARD

The subjects reported on in report cards are fixed ahead of time. Report cards measure progress against expectations. They provide accountability for the vision and the performance.

A shliach’s vision, objective, strategy, and approach to implementation are never final. Evaluating performance, monitoring changes, and making adjustments are normal and necessary. Proficient strategy execution is always the product of much organizational learning. This is why crafting a strategy is a process and not an event.

“Success can be measured on many levels,” says Rabbi Groner. “By how many people come to programs, how well you are accepted in the community, the level of trust, and on the individual level when people become baalei teshuvah.”

You must therefore “quantify the intangibles,” says Rabbi Marcus. What results does the Chabad



Sample Chabad House Report Card

The Chabad House	Shul	Office	Lobby	Simcha Hall	Kitchen
Cleanliness					
Orderliness					
Friendliness					
The Staff	Shliach	Shlucha	Secretary	Bookkeeper	Coordinator
Communication					
Preparedness					
Planning					
Delegation					
Presentability					
Programs & Events	Shiurim	Holiday Events	Shul	Fundraiser	Shabbos
Coordination					
Punctuality					
Attendance					
New Faces					
Toichen					
Finances	Daily Goals	Weekly Goals	Monthly Goals	Annual Goals	Personal
Fundraising					
Budgeting					
Bookkeeping					

House want to produce? How are you going to measure people's connection, the sense of community, their growth in Yiddishkeit?

Rabbi Marcus breaks down the strategy into three stages:

- 1) Building connections
- 2) Building communities
- 3) Moving people up in Yiddishkeit

These are aspects that need to be reported on so that you can measure success against your expectations. So that you can modify programs to continuously meet the needs of your community. Only then can you adequately report on the overall progress of your Chabad House to determine if you are successfully moving in the direction of your vision.

CONCLUSION

The consensus is that leadership is “doing the right things” while management is “doing things right.” Clarifying missions, vision, and objectives

is “doing the right things”, wheres management is a responsible for “doing things right” through strategy and operations.

The Rebbe said the difference between a shliach and an askan is that the askan does things for the community while the shliach becomes part of the community. Every shliach must challenge himself and ask, “Am I fulfilling my potential? How can I be more successful? What’s holding me back? Am I working for the community or am I becoming a part of it?”

If you are failing, make sure you know where you are failing. We can’t solve problems with the same kind of thinking we used when we created them.

On a leadership level each shliach must posses a willingness and desire to evolve as a leader. On the management level, shluchim are under a lot of pressure and don’t have the time, but they must make the time.

With Hashem’s help, the dream is becoming a reality; the time to plan for “the plan” is now. 

COST CUTTING TIPS

Contributing Shluchim: Rabbis Simcha Backman, Yossi Lazaroff, Elchonon Tenenbaum, Chesky Tenenbaum, Sruli Deitsch, Yosef Eisenbach, Mrs. Dini Gurevitz, Mrs. Chana Benjaminson

Whether stationed in a community of five thousand or five hundred thousand, every shliach works to make the most of an often tight budget, stretching every dollar to provide for his community and family alike. There are some simple ways, however, that can make cost cutting easier and more effective, without being too time consuming.

REEVALUATE YOUR BILLS

Rabbi Simcha Backman, Shliach in Glendale, CA and Director of ShluchimExchange, for example, recommends that shluchim reevaluate their personal and commercial mortgages as a way to save money.

“In this economic climate, banks are very open to negotiation,” says Rabbi Backman, who has been personally successful in this area. “Even if they agree to adjust your rate for



SAVE MONEY ONLINE

The following websites also come highly recommended:

Amazon.com/Mom offers members 15% off baby products, including diapers.

Amazon.com/Subscribeandsave offers another 15% off when you request regular deliveries of your purchases.

Dansdeals.com is a general bargain finding site.

Ebates.com offers rebates on members' online purchases.

Kosheronabudget.com advertises daily and weekly kosher deals.

Kolleldeals.com has metzias on everything from convection ovens and pots to keyboards and ladders.

Swagbucks.com offers coupon points for using its search engine.

Moxicopy.com provides free shipping when you print newsletters, cards, stationery, or other items, and even accepts small orders.

Mint.com is free personal finance software to assist you in managing your money, financial planning and budget planning.

Annualcreditreport.com allows you to order a credit report once every twelve months from each of the nationwide consumer credit reporting companies: TransUnion, Equifax, and Experian.

a few years, it can save you a few thousand dollars a month.”

Rabbi Backman also emphasizes the importance of examining your bills, at least every few months. This is because rates and promotions are constantly changing, and it is crucial not only to secure new deals, but also to ensure that companies are not overcharging you.

“Just make sure that there’s nothing out of the ordinary on your bills,” he says. “If you’re overcharged monthly, it makes a big difference. Pay attention to your bills and you can save big money.”

Important areas to review bills include phones, bank statements and credit cards. These types of companies are more likely to add new fees, which can often occur incrementally, or present inadvertent mistakes.

SHOP FOR DISCOUNTS

Rabbi Yossi Lazaroff, Shliach at Texas A&M University, finds cost cutting most effective when purchasing goods.

According to him, bulk discount stores, such as Costco or Sam’s Club, now provide many products that shluchim can use, such as cholov Yisroel cheeses, cold cuts, and even pas Yisroel pizza crusts.

“All you need to do is request these items at your local store and they will carry them for you,” says Rabbi Lazaroff.

Taking advantage of collective buying power with other shluchim, such as discounts with Office Depot, is also a good way to save money.

“Printing at Office Depot ends up being cheaper than doing it at home,” explains Rabbi Lazaroff. “The shluchim discount is automatically applied to your credit card, and you can save over 50 percent on big printing jobs there. I find a lot of good advice with these things on the Shluchim Exchange.”

The newly formed CPN (Chabad Purchasing Network) is bringing this concept to the next level by adding discounts on gas cards, phone systems, insurance, paper goods and many other useful items.

Rabbi Lazaroff also suggests taking

into account the cost of time, not just money. For example, if you pay someone hourly to do the laundry or ironing in your home, you may actually discover that it is less expensive to send your items to a cleaner instead.

NEGOTIATE AND CONSOLIDATE

Rabbi Elchonon Tenenbaum, Shliach in Napa Valley, California, suggests consolidating phones, using voice over IP as a primary phone line, and joining family plans with other shluchim when possible. He emphasizes finding the best deal for cell phone and other plans as a way to save money.

He has also had much success when negotiating with local businesses for a low rate. “I always ask the companies to work with me on price,” says Rabbi Tenenbaum, who finds that businesses will even throw in extra promotions if asked. “They often go down a third in price or more, especially in this economy. In home maintenance, contracted jobs, programs, speakers, really any area, they will work with you to fit a tight budget.”

UTILIZE COUPONS

Rabbi Tenenbaum also uses local coupons to his advantage, such as buying six oil changes for his car in advance. Such a promotion can save some 70 cents to the dollar.

Mrs. Dini Gurevitz, Shlucha in Abington, Pennsylvania, alerts herself to grocery store circulars and children’s store coupons or promotions. The home store Bed, Bath, and Beyond, offers 20 percent off coupons which can be applied even months after a purchase, and boasts an exceptional return and replacement policy.

And **Rabbi Chesky Tenenbaum**, Shliach in Upper Montgomery County, Maryland, suggests purchasing a gas card from the gas station that you use most often. “You can get up to five percent back on every purchase of gas with one of these cards,” says Rabbi Tenenbaum. “And if you qualify, you can get a tax exempt gas card and save over 18 cents a gallon.”

CPN’s negotiations with Exxon Mobil produced a card that can be used at 95% of gas stations nationwide (not

Save Money on Air Conditioning Costs This Summer

BY JEREMY VOHWINNKE, FINANCIAL PLANNER

Summer is approaching, and with the warm weather comes increased cooling costs. While there are a number of different ways you can save money during the summer months, the air conditioner tends to be the biggest energy gorger. Any appliance that uses electricity to alter temperature is generally inefficient by nature. This includes heaters, hot water heaters, refrigerators, and so on. Fortunately, there are some things you can do to help maximize your air conditioning efficiency.



Perform **regular maintenance** on your air conditioning unit. Replace the filter

monthly during the cooling season and have a professional service your system at the beginning of each cooling season.

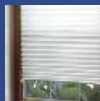


If you have a central air unit, make sure the **condenser** is located in a shady spot

and has room to dispose of the heated air it removes from your house. Don’t crowd it with shrubs or anything else.

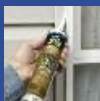


Install a **programmable thermostat** so you can vary the temperature according to when you’re home. Set it for a lower temperature when you’re home. If you’ll be gone for more than a few hours, it makes sense to set the air conditioning at a higher temperature while you’re gone.



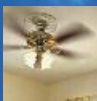
Close drapes or shades on the sunny side of your house. The sun has intense

warming effects, and when it is allowed to enter a window without the heat being able to escape, it will act like a greenhouse. Keep as much direct sunlight out as possible to keep your home a few degrees cooler.



Seal up air leaks in your house. Just as drafts can find their way into your house in the winter, hot air does the same thing during the summer. Caulk or seal places where utilities come into your home (plumbing, electricity, dryer vents, etc.). Fill gaps around chimneys and weatherstrip around drafty windows and doors.

Utilize fans as much as possible. If the temperature is just



slightly uncomfortable, consider using an oscillating fan, or ceiling fan if you have one. Just a slight breeze or circulation caused by fans can make it feel a few degrees cooler.



Turn off the lights when not in use. If you have standard incandescent bulbs, they generate a good deal of heat. Having lights on when not necessary just increases the temperature in the house. Consider switching to CFL bulbs, which run cool, and also consume less electricity.

These are just a few of many different ways you can cut down on your cooling costs this summer. If the going gets tough, you can also do so by making a point to spend more time in public air conditioned facilities.

just Exxon). “Exxon has assigned dedicated representatives to help you attain tax exempt status and join the program,” says **Rabbi Sruli Deitsch**, Director of Sales at CPN. “If you already have a gas card and set up your tax documents properly, they will switch you over to this one so you won’t be limited to just one gas company.”

EDIT YOUR SHOPPING LISTS

Mrs. Gurevitz suggests that another way to find yourself with some extra money in your account is to adjust your Shabbos menus to include fewer and less expensive dishes. She recommends paying only with cash if times are tough, and if possible, stocking up on items that you find at a good price. Free shopper’s rewards cards can save you money on your grocery bills as well.

Mrs. Chana Benjaminson, Shlucha in South Coast, Massachusetts, has found that supermarkets frequently restock their produce shelves and place produce that is still in great shape on the half-off sale rack. Local farms or small produce stores often offer great prices if you buy in bulk and may even deliver to your home.

Becoming familiar with the state and local programs that the government has to offer can be a big assistance as well.

FIND VOLUNTEERS

Rabbi Yosef Eisenbach, Shliach in Northwest Connecticut, recommends finding volunteers from your community to provide services. The key is to determine what needs to be done and find people who are appropriate for the job.

Volunteers can be useful in some of

the following areas:

- Babysitting
- Organization of your home or office
- Musical or other performance for your events
- Home repair or maintenance
- Gardening
- Photography and videography
- Documenting Chabad activities via scrapbooking or graphic design.

Whether the one-time savings are large or small, the cumulative worth does add up. Take a few moments to reevaluate your bills, shop for discounts, negotiate and consolidate, utilize coupons, edit your shopping lists, find volunteers, and look for ways to save money online. Even if you’re not tight with money right now, it doesn’t hurt to put a few extra coins in the bank, does it? 

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- Exxon Mobil Gas Cards
- Copy Machines
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- Major Appliances

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FOR MORE INFO CONTACT
Rabbi Sruli Deitsch | Director of Sales

Phone: 718-467-4400 x 349 | **Fax:** 718-510-8151
Email: Sales@kinus.com